Agile Turn

Recruitment Suite

AI Candidate Search — Query Guide

For Recruiters, Hiring Managers & Admins · July 2026

1. What the search does

Type a natural-language query. Agile Turn extracts skills, years, and location; hard-filters matching candidates; recalls with semantic (meaning) and full-text (exact words) search; fuses both with Reciprocal Rank Fusion; then re-ranks by skill, experience, and location fit.

2. Best query formula

```
[Role / specialty] + [1–3 known skills] + [years] + [location]
```

Example query	Filters applied
React developer Bangalore 5 years	react · "e5 yrs · bangalore
Python AWS remote 3+ years	python, aws · "e3 yrs · remote
Node.js TypeScript in Hyderabad	nodejs, typescript · hyderabad
Senior Java Spring Boot	Soft rank only for Spring Boot (not a hard alias)

Tips

- Prefer 2–4 concrete terms over long paragraphs.
- Name must-have skills explicitly (React, Python, AWS…).
- Add years when seniority matters (5 years, 3+ years, minimum 4 years).
- Add location with “in …”, “based in …”, or remote / hybrid / wfh.
- Do not list every nice-to-have — known skills become hard must-haves (max 5).

3. Hard filters vs soft ranking

Signal	Behavior
Known skills (alias list)	Hard — must have ALL detected (up to 5)
Years of experience	Hard — total_experience "e N when detected
Location	Hard — preferred location contains the hint
Other words / job titles	Soft — semantic + full-text ranking only

Too few results !’ loosen (drop a skill, years, or location). Too broad !’ add a known skill, years, or “in <city>”.

4. Experience phrases

- 5 years / 5 yrs
- 5+ years
- 5 years of experience
- at least 5 years · minimum 5 years · min 5 years

5. Location phrases

- in Bangalore · based in Pune · located in Mumbai · from Delhi
- remote · wfh · work from home · hybrid

Matching is a simple contains check on preferred work location — keep city names plain.

6. Known skills (hard-filter aliases)

Only these (and common spellings like React.js, Node JS, k8s) become hard must-haves. Other skills still help ranking via text/semantic search.

- Frontend/JS: react, vue, angular, svelte, nextjs, javascript, typescript, nodejs
- Languages: python, java, kotlin, go, rust, csharp, cpp
- Data/backend: postgresql, mysql, mongodb, redis, graphql, rest
- Cloud/DevOps: aws, azure, gcp, docker, kubernetes, terraform, cicd
- Practices: agile, scrum, git, github, gitlab

Aliases: React.js!'react · Node JS!'nodejs · amazon web services!'aws · k8s!'kubernetes · C#!'csharp

7. Good vs weak queries

Prefer

```
React TypeScript Bangalore 4 years
Python data engineer remote 5+ years
Java AWS Docker in Pune minimum 3 years
```

Avoid

Vague essays ("really strong full stack who knows everything") — few hard signals. Long laundry lists of every skill — almost nobody matches all hard filters.

8. Reading results

- Final score — blend of semantic fit, skill overlap, experience, location.
- Recommendation reason — short "why this person" explanation.
- Parsed intent (must-have skills, years, location) — verify filters when debugging empty results.

9. Privacy & scope

Search returns only candidates in your data silo (owned candidates). Admins see the full tenant. Job assignments do not grant search access to another user's candidates.

10. Quick checklist

- Named 1–3 known skills
- Added years if seniority matters
- Added city or remote if location matters
- Kept the query short and specific
- If empty !' remove one hard constraint and search again